

BEYOND THE BASICS: ENHANCING ROAD SAFETY IN QATAR

PROBLEM

According to the World Health Organization, road traffic crashes are the leading cause for children and young adults. They are a significant threat to societies, causing deaths, injuries, and disabilities, along with economic and social challenges.

After a decline during the World Cup 2022, Qatar witnessed a surge in traffic violations, as of May 2023, marking a **12.6%** increase.

Alarming statistics include a **54%** rise in deaths from traffic accidents, totalling **209,394** incidents, with the highest numbers by over speeding (125,635), traffic movement violations (23,761), and stand-and-wait rule violations (30,219) contributing significantly to the spike.

Young Drivers (18-24) face a higher risk of severe injuries or fatalities in road accidents due to their age and limited driving experience compared to other drivers:

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

Germany is 7th out of 27 EU countries in terms of the lowest numbers of fatalities per million inhabitants and successfully decreased this number over the past twenty years:

Qatar Laws

- Required Age for Driving License:** 18 years (optional 17 years with accompany)
- Penalty Point System:** Implemented penalty point system leading to loose the driving license for certain period of time.
- Seat Belt Enforcement:** Regulation for seat belt duty for front seats.
- Speed Laws:** Speed limit regulations as well definition of violation for low speed on the left line.
- Adequate Signals and Space:** Laws enforce to maintain safe following distance and the duty of signals.
- Overtaking:** Law for the overtake from the left only.
- Giving priority:** Definition for giving priority to cars moving on road junctions.

German Laws

- Required Age for Driving License:** 18 years (optional 17 years with accompany) German law clearly defines regulations for the accompanying person
- Penalty Point System:** Implemented penalty point system leading to loose the driving license for certain period of time.
- Seat Belt Enforcement:** Regulation for seat belt duty for all passengers.
- Speed Laws:** Speed limit regulations except for motorways as well definition of violation for low speed on the left line.
- Adequate Signals and Space:** Laws enforce to maintain safe following distance and the duty of signals.
- Overtaking:** Law for the overtake from the left only.
- Giving priority:** Definition for giving priority to cars moving on road junctions.

STAKEHOLDERS & PARTNERSHIP

CURRENT PROCESS

Registration

Find and register in a driving school & submit the required documents
3 to 5 months

Theory Class

5 theoretical classes

Practical Class

40 practical classes

Test

Answering no less than 37/40 in the theoretical test perform multiple parking techniques and test your proficiency on the road for around 10 minutes

Issuance

Issuance of the driving licences

14 Theoretical classes

30 Practical classes
5 classes on federal/ country roads
7 classes: 4 x highway, 3 x dusk or dark

Germany focus on high competence driving skills such as anticipatory driving, or priority regulation, respecting the overtaking ban, etc.

Qatar Process

German Process

NEW PROCESS

INPUTS

- Data Collection:**
 - Gather data on current accident statistics, traffic violations, and driving-related deaths.
 - Comparison between Qatari traffic laws and German traffic laws
 - Collect feedback from new drivers about their involvement in traffic accidents. (Survey)
- Expert Consultations**
- International Best Practices:**
 - Study successful driver training programs in other countries.
- Technology and Simulators**
- Collaborations with Stakeholders and Partners**

OUTPUTS

- Results:**
 - Traffic statistics.
 - How many people finished the program.
- Training Materials:**
 - Develop anticipatory driving manuals, videos, and other educational resources.
- Young drivers being well-trained and aware of safer and responsible driving practices**
- Trained Instructors**
- Establishing Fruitful Collaborations throughout the Process**

RELEVANT SDGs

3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

11 SUSTAINABLE CITIES AND COMMUNITIES

ACTIVITIES

- Training Programs for Drivers:**
 - Implement theoretical classes on anticipatory driving.
 - Integrate driving simulators into the training process.
 - Conduct practical training sessions with a focus on anticipatory skills.
- Instructor Training:**
 - Train driving instructors on the new training program and teaching methodologies.
- Setting up Meetings with Collaborators (stakeholders and partners)**

SHORT TERM OUTCOMES

- Monitoring and evaluating new drivers' accidents/ violations involvement and death rate in the first 2 years of driving (survey)**
- Improvement of driving practices among young drivers**

LONG TERM OUTCOMES

- Reduced Accidents, Violations and Deaths**
- Cultural Shift:**
 - A cultural shift towards safer driving habits
- Improved Traffic Flow:**
 - Enhanced Traffic flow due to better-prepared drivers.
- Evaluating New Drivers' Accidents/ Violations involvement and death rate in 5 years of driving (survey)**

BUDGET

Overviews of budget	Total Costs
I. Personal Costs	1,125,000.00
II. Major Equipment	943,000.00
III. Optional Costs	600,000.00
External Costs Total	2,668,000.00